Astounding, reached the newsstands on November 19, and only ten days later, on the twenty-ninth, I got my first copies of the book.

As a faint echo, the December 1952 Galaxy contained "The Deep/' 1 and the February 1953 Startling had "The Monkey's Fingers/' 2

Then too, though Fred had said he liked "The Pause," it was apparently vetoed by the publishers. However, some days later, on December 2, he said he would take "Nobody Here but—" instead. I couldn't complain. The second was the better story, in my own opinion.

On the same day on which I received the book version of The Cur-rents of Space, I finally began the new novel, The Caves of Steel. I also began putting together "Now You See It—" and "—And Now You Don't," at Marty Greenberg's suggestion, to prepare the final volume of the Foundation series, Second Foundation.

Not so pleasant as all this was the fact that on December 4, Planet had put out a magazine called Tops in Science Fiction, which reprinted "Black Friar of the Flame."

1 See The Martian Way and Other Stories.

2 See Buy Jupiter and Other Stories.

I was annoyed for two reasons. In the first place, they didn't ask my permission, and if they had, I would have forbidden it, since it was not a good story and would reflect poorly on my reputation of the 1950s. Second, since they did reprint it, they might have paid me, but they didn't.

Unfortunately, they were quite within their rights in doing this, since they owned all rights to the story and could reprint without additional payment at any time. Other magazines did it, too, and often with my poorest stories. The January 1951 Super Science, for instance, reprinted "Victory Unintentional." And early in 1953, Thrilling Wonder put out Wonder Story Annual, which reprinted "Christmas on Ganymede."

On balance, though, when the Thanksgiving season came about I had numerous reasons to give thanks, and it was fitting that Gertrude got a ten-pound turkey with which to celebrate a traditional Thanksgiving all by ourselves (plus David) for the first time.

It turned out very well indeed, and Gertrude managed it just as well as ever